

■ PERSONAL COMPUTERS

PC demand in India grows, IDC reports 14% growth YoY in Q3

The sales of personal computers and laptops had seen a decline in the second quarter of 2023 owing to many reasons. But now as the data from the third quarter of the year, that is from July to September, is coming forward, we see a change in that trend. Let's see how the sales have fared this time as compared to the previous quarter.

The traditional PC market in India includes desktops, notebooks, and workstations. A recent report by IDC revealed promising statistics. The market saw a 14% year-on-year (YoY) increase reaching 4.5 million units in the third quarter of the year. This is promising when compared to the 15.3% year-on-year decline seen in the last quarter (Q2 2023). Speaking of the



individual categories, the notebook category saw 13.1%, while the desktop category grew by 19.3%. Further, a 26.3 YoY growth was seen in the consumer segment, while the commercial segment stayed steady.

The consumer segment's growth was a good change compared to the slump in Q2 of 2023. Remember the government had issued a notice regarding mandatory import licenses on PCs. This

was supposed to start on October 30 but was put on hold. In lieu of this, vendors had arranged for inventory so that there was no shortage of supplies or price hikes with the festive season sales around the corner.

Let's now take a look at the companies that did better than the others in Q3 or 2023.

The market was led by HP which accounted for a 29.4% market share. It held a 34.3% share in the commercial segment and a 25.9% share in the consumer segment. Lenovo stood second with a 17% market share. It was followed by Dell Technologies having a 14.6% and ASUS with a 12.5% market share respectively.

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■ PROCESSORS

Qualcomm's Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 has 15% faster CPU and 50% better GPU

Qualcomm's Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chipset was quite the buzz of the tech town as it was the most premium chipset offered by the company. Qualcomm has now announced the new Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 chipset, the successor of the Snapdragon 7 Gen 1. This has been crafted for mid-range smartphones.

The Qualcomm Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 chipset has an octa-core design with a 1+3+4 CPU core layout. Further, the chipset is based on TSMC's 4nm process technology. Additionally, the chipset features a single prime core which is clocked at a max 2.63GHz, in addition to 3x performance cores at 2.40GHz and 4x efficiency cores at

1.8GHz. However, Qualcomm is yet to share the exact core specifications. So, we'll have to wait and see which Kryo cores Qualcomm will incorporate.

If we compare it to the Snapdragon 7 Gen 1, the Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 will be 15% faster than its predecessor. The company even added that this new chipset will be 20% more power efficient. Further-

more, the GPU in the Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 will be over 50% more powerful than the Snapdragon 7 Gen 1. Speaking of AI, Qualcomm says that it has a 60% improved AI performance per watt compared to Snapdragon 7 Gen 1.

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